



Public Speaking 101: Openings That Orient

College • Communications / public speaking

Course objective

Design an accurate informative-speech opening for a defined audience. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

College • Communications / public speaking; Course objective. Focus: Design an accurate informative-speech opening for a defined audience.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 2 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

An informative opening draws attention, names the topic, shows audience relevance, establishes an honest basis for speaking, and previews the route. Do not invent personal experience, statistics, credentials, or sources. A hypothetical situation must be labeled hypothetical. This introductory college practice has no accreditation or universal course-equivalency claim.

Model 1 • Improve “Today I talk about files” for students losing drafts.

Imagine opening three files called final. Today I will demonstrate a naming routine for class drafts: a date, a topic, and a version. The imagined problem connects to the audience and previews three parts.

Model 2 • Can a student say “Research proves this always works” without a source?

No. Replace it with a bounded demonstration claim: I will show one organizing method you can test.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Fictional speaking brief

Audience: first-year students who write on shared computers. Purpose: explain a file-naming routine, not endorse an app. Demonstration: use YYYY-MM-DD_topic_v01, increase the version number after major revisions, and keep the class's required submission name for the final upload. A filename alone is not a backup. The assignment is a 60–90-second opening, not a full technical-security lesson. The speaker may honestly say they practiced this demonstration if they actually did.



Sample opening for analysis

Imagine finding four documents called final before class. Which one contains your latest revision? Today I will show a simple naming routine for working drafts. I have prepared two sample files for this demonstration. We will label the date, add a topic, and update the version number. Keep your instructor's required filename for submission; this routine is for organizing your working copies.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. Name the specific audience and one likely need.

2. Is the sample hook a factual statistic? Explain.

3. Identify the topic statement.

4. Identify the preview's three steps.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. What is the limited credibility claim?

6. How should a speaker revise that claim if no files were prepared?

7. What boundary about submission is stated?

8. Why is “This method prevents every lost file” inaccurate?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Write an audience-relevant question hook without inventing a statistic.

10. Write a neutral informative purpose statement.

11. Write a three-part preview in logical order.

12. Add one limitation without derailing the opening.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Rewrite the hook for an audience already using version control.

14. Draft a 60-90-second opening on separate paper.

15. Read it aloud and record elapsed time. Revise if needed.

16. Ask a listener to repeat the three steps. Record and use feedback.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. New topic: demonstrate how to label a classroom plant-care log. Write an honest hook.

18. State the topic and audience benefit.

19. Write a three-part preview and an honest credibility line.

20. Give a short opening and self-assess against five components.



Answers and response criteria

1. First-year students using shared computers; distinguishing drafts without assuming they are all inexperienced.
2. No. It is explicitly an imagined scenario.
3. Today I will show a simple naming routine for working drafts.
4. Label date, add topic, update version number.
5. Speaker prepared two sample files; true only if actually prepared.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. Prepare the files before speaking or remove/rewrite honestly; never claim nonexistent work.
7. Follow instructor's required filename for submission; routine applies to working copies.
8. Naming helps organization but does not guarantee saving, backups, permissions, or recovery.
9. Example: How do you tell which draft you revised most recently? Relevant and not falsely quantified.
10. Example: I will explain a three-part draft filename. Not "I will prove this is the only good system."

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. Date, topic, version; preserve clear sequence or justify another coherent order.
12. Example: Names help us identify files, but we still need a backup. Accurate and brief.
13. Acknowledge experience and focus on readable exported/submitted drafts; avoid implying no existing skill.
14. Require attention, topic, audience relevance, honest credibility, preview, and appropriate limit. Time actual delivery; word count alone is not proof.
15. Accept actual measured duration plus cuts/additions that maintain essential components; no invented time.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Record what listener actually recalls; revise unclear preview or signposting. Solo alternative: pause then reconstruct outline before checking.

17. Relevant question or labeled hypothetical, no fabricated research/statistics.

18. Explain recording date, observation, and action so classmates can interpret the log; no guaranteed plant-health claim.

19. Preview date/observation/action; say you prepared a sample only if true, or state what will be demonstrated without credential claims.

20. Attention, topic, relevance, honest basis, preview all present. Accept written/audio/live format; evaluate organization and accuracy, not accent or eye-contact norms.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

Introductory college course-level skill practice; no accreditation, guaranteed transfer, credential, or universal course equivalency is claimed.

University teaching reference • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://www.unr.edu/writing-speaking-center/writing-speaking-resources/speech-introductions>

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